LECTURE 1

THE EVOLUTION OF PUBLIC RELATIONS [US, EUROPE & MALAYSIA]

Public Relations & Definition

A deliberate planned and sustained effort to establish and maintain mutual understanding between an organization and its publics – *The British Institute of Public Relations*

Public relations is concerned with or devoted to creating mutual understanding among groups and institutions – *Public Relations Society of America*

A management function that identifies, establishes and maintains mutually beneficial relationships between an organisation and its publics upon whom its success depends – *Cutlip, Center and Broom*

Public Relations consists of all forms of planned communication both inward and outward between an organisation and its publics for the purpose of achieving objectives concerning mutual understanding – *Frank Jefkins*

Public relations is “the management of communication between an organization and its publics.”Grunig and Hunt (1984),

Management. The body of knowledge on how best to coordinate the activities of an enterprise to achieve effectiveness.

Communication. Not only sending a message to a receiver but also understanding the messages of others through listening and dialogue.

Organization. Any group organized with a common purpose; in most cases, it is a business, a corporation, a governmental agency, or a nonprofit group.

Publics. Any group(s) of people held together by a common interest.
Differ from audiences in that they often self-organize and do not have to attune to messages; Differ from stakeholders in that they do not necessarily have a financial stake tying them to specific goals or consequences of the organization. Targeted audiences, on the other hand, are publics who receive a specifically targeted message that is tailored to their interests.

TYPE AND FUNCTION OF PUBLIC RELATIONS

TYPE OF PUBLIC RELATIONS	FUNCTIONS OF PUBLIC RELATIONS
Government Public Relations	Media relations
Marketing Communication	Managing corporate identity, images and reputation
Investor / financial relations	Preparing communication materials
Employee relations	Managing organizational' communication channels
Sports and health communication	'Buying' public support
Non-Governmental Organization	Managing public opinion

Where & When was the practice of Public Relations begin?

1. If, you look for ‘the practice or the activities-like of PR’ then the answer will be; it was started by the Babylonian / Sumerians civilization (which is now in Iraq) – The evidence was found on some messages scrawled on mud-brick walls around 3,000 years ago.

2. The term ‘Public Relations’ was probably use for first time in the US in the 19th century.

Public Relations in the USA.

The Publicity and press agentry by entertainment industry

Use mainly by the circuses touring around the US. This was later identified as the beginning of what we called now as ‘celebrity PR’ and ‘Product publicity’

The publicity and press agentry by the economically richer organizations; railroad company, oil and gas company, public utilities company.

This was identified as the beginning of the modern public relations and corporate communication.

STATEMENT FROM THE ROAD.

It Declares the Rails on the Bridge Must Have Fitted Exactly.

Special to The New York Times.

PHILADELPHIA, Oct. 29.—This statement relative to the Atlantic City disaster was authorized by the Pennsylvania Railroad Company to-day:

On account of the difficulty of raising the trucks of the cars out of the water the railroad officials have not been able to discover the cause of the accident. They have ascertained, however, that there was no defect in either the drawbridge or its mechanism to cause the derailment. The bridge—both stationary and movable parts—is of the most approved modern type.

General Manager Atterbury is on the ground supervising the work of raising the trucks. Their great weight has so far defied the efforts of the wrecking apparatus, but attempts are still being made to get them to the surface. When they are examined, the railroad officials think, it will be shown that there was something about one of the trucks that caused the train to leap the track.

It is certain that the rails on the drawbridge and those on the solid section fitted exactly, for otherwise the signal could never have shown a clear track. By means of the interlocking system it is impossible for the motorman to get the "go ahead" signal until the rails are exactly in place.

The Pennsylvania Railroad Company is leaving nothing undone to get at the cause of the accident. The Coroner has already gathered a jury and is making a thorough investigation; the officials of the company are giving him every assistance in their power.

Public Relations in Europe

Germany industrial giant, Krupp, established a News Bureau in 1893.

Friedrich Krupp establish a cast steel making factory in 1811

Marconi Company in the UK sent out its first Press Release in 1910.

The first British Public Relations agency, Editorial Services, was set up in London in 1924

When businesses were set-up across the boundaries, the need for public relations and corporate communication function become more important. Leading to Marketing-led or consumer public relations with its highly publicity tactical style / approach.

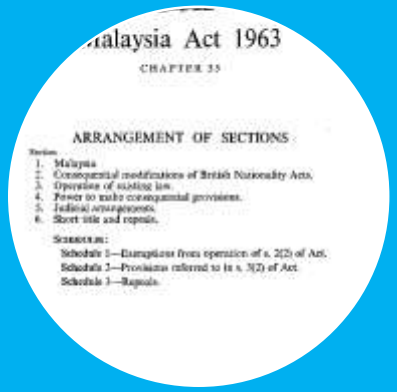
Public Relations in Malaysia

Before World War 2 - 1939

After World War 2

(1945 – 1957)

1957 – the formation of Malaysia



1963 - 1980

1980 - 2003

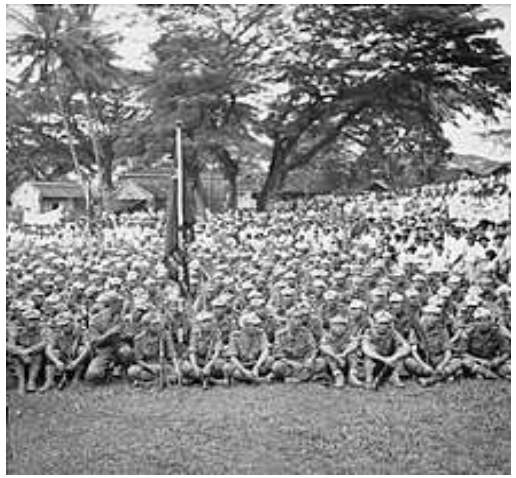
Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 1 – Before 1939

- Information department established in 1939 to garnered support
- British were involved in a war in Europe
- Information department serve as a press bureau

- G.L Peet, first director of Info. Dept. He was veteran journalist with The Straits Times.
- 1941 Information Department and Publicity was formed to replaced Info. Dept.
- Dr Victor Purcell was the new Director

- Disseminate the publicity on war
- To issue official information;
- Disseminating news through government department
- To work closely with the Ministry of Information, London and the Far Eastern Bureau in Singapore

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 2 After WW2 - 1957



- BMA – Malayan Union – the establishment of department of public relations
- Mubin Sheppard was appointed as the first director

- 'To instil in the minds of Malayan that the British were not defeated during WW2 but instead withdrew to India, to prepare for a counterattack. - The need to restore its reputation, defeated by an Asian power

- To restore law and order, racial riot, Police force were disbanded.
- To organize campaign to urge people to grow rice and vegetables to overcome shortages in food. One of the earliest campaign organized by the government

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 2 After WW2 - 1957

Dept of Public Relations were established in every states

Become the nucleus of Department of Information

1952 Department of Information was formed. Launch the psychological warfare against the communist insurgent (1948 – 1960)

Remain as the most successful PR campaign ever organized by the government

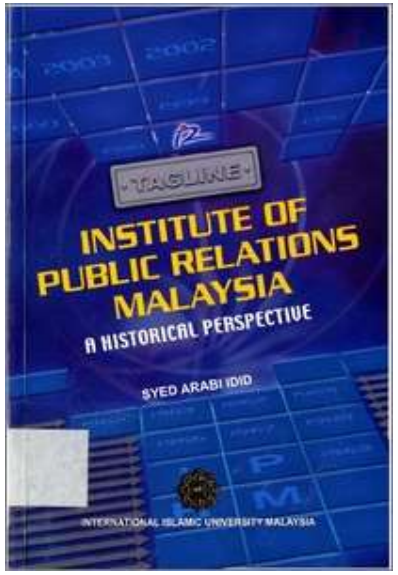
Information department of Sarawak was established in 1951

Information department was tasked to educate the citizen on their role as a citizen of independence nation; 1957 (achieving independence) & 1959 (first election)

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 3 1957 - 1963

Newspaper HQs, Radio Stations were moved to KL
Radio stations were put under the purview of Prime Minister office

Insurgency Information Services was launch
To mobilize public opinion to support the government action against the communist.



1962 – Institute of Public Relations of Malaysia was formed

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 4 1963 - 1980

Malaysia – Indonesia confrontation

The Straits Times

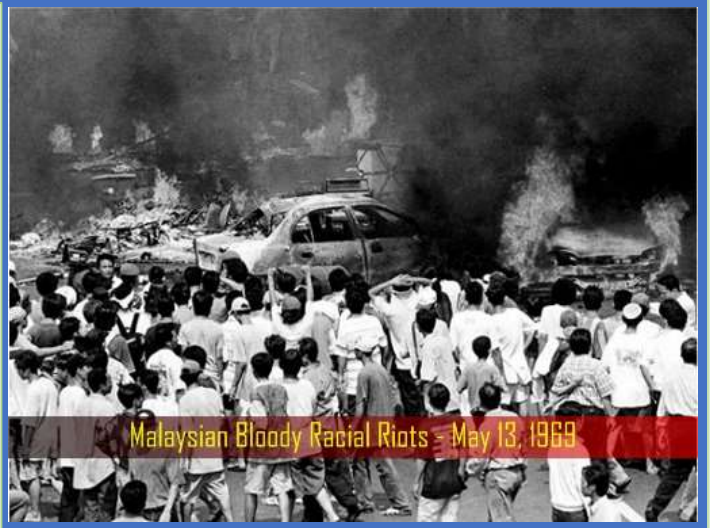
The Tengku on TV appeals for calm and order

Still tense: 75 dead so far

Malaysian Govt suspends all newspapers

Trading room remains closed today

SAFETY FIRST!



May 13th, 1969 Racial riot in Kuala Lumpur

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 4 1963 - 1980

Impact of Indonesia confrontation to the development of public relations in Malaysia.

Foreign Office established Office of External Information headed by Ahmad Nordin Md Zain (president of IPRM)

The needs to communicate Malaysia' stand with foreign countries

Through foreign diplomacy, Malaysia received helps from other commonwealth country i.e Australia and New Zealand to fight against Indonesia

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 4 1963 - 1980

Implications from the racial riot, May 13th

1. MAGERAN form several committee to analyse the reason behind the riot.

2. Tun Sambathan headed one committee and found that lacks dissemination of government policies lead to the dissatisfaction among races in Malaysia

3. The report suggested that a Public Relations Officer be appointed at every ministries.

4. 1978, 7 public relations officer with a diploma in mass communication were appointed as a pioneer – Mark the participation of people with proper qualification

5. PMO and Deputy PM office were given a Press Secretary

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 4 1963 - 1980

Government set up The National News Agency – BERNAMA in 1967

Berita Nasional Malaysia serve as the news agent for the government

The Malaysian National News Agency or BERNAMA, a statutory body, was set up by an Act of Parliament in 1967 and began operations in May 1968.

BERNAMA's role as a source of reliable and latest news is well known among local & international media including government agencies, corporations, universities and individuals nationwide.

Evolution of Public Relations in Malaysia: Phase 5 1980 - 2003

- Marked by the era of Mahathir administration
- Public relations practice flourished due to the good economy performance as well as with the introduction of several new policies.
- Industrialization policy – establishing lots of industries that required good PR practice
- Privatization policy – Several government department turn into private entity. PR function more than just news disseminator!
- Economic prosperity– foreign direct investment, expanding of companies' operation all needs good PR practice.
- During economic recession in 1997, most organization uses the service offered by PR consultant.

The Actor in Public Relations

Government & Private Public Relations officers

Public Relations consultants – Company that is offering communication solution to their clients

Public relations freelancers – Offering specialise communication solutions, depending on their expertise i.e speech writer / media relations

Public relations academic – Those at the university that are shaping the thinking, theory and philosophy of the practice.

Public Relations & Professional Body

Established in March 1962

To encourage and to advance professional practice of public relations in Malaysia.

Main activities – training & education

Public Relations & Academic Institution

Malaysia has accepted PR as an academic discipline.

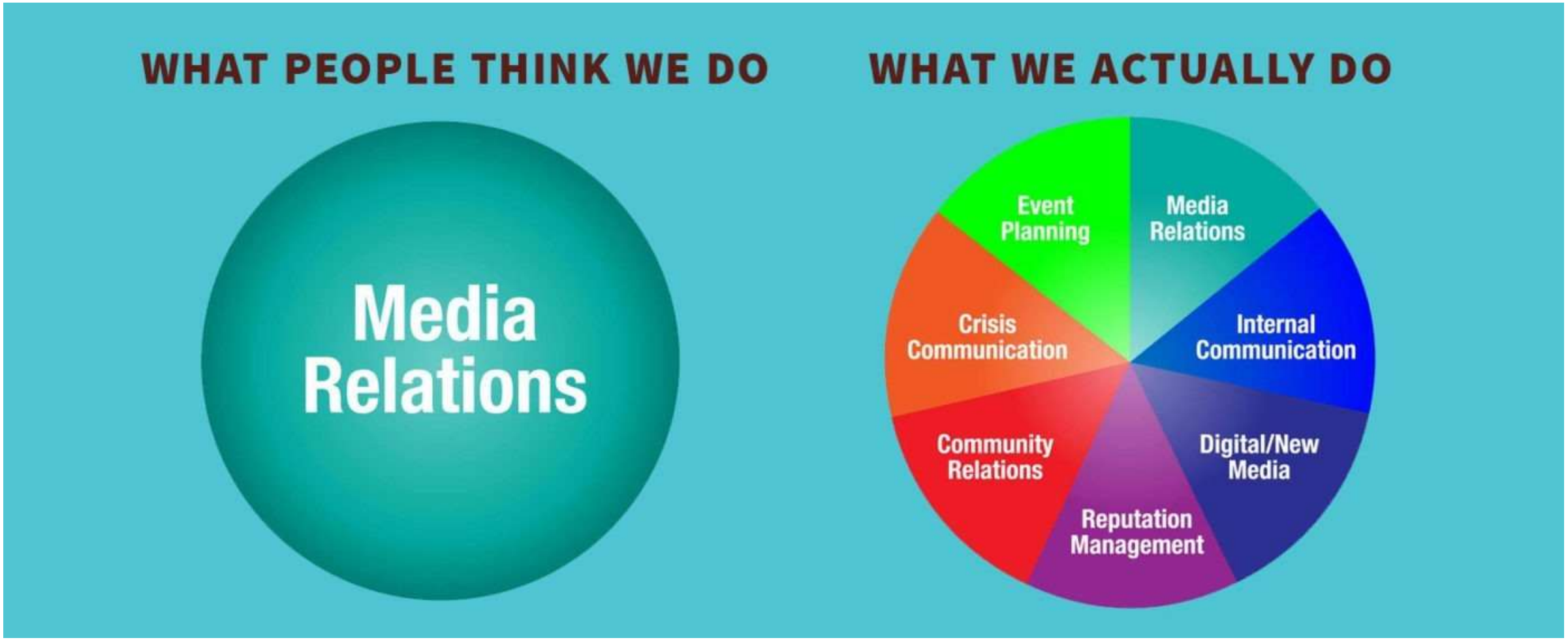
PR courses were introduced in universities - 1971-USM and 1972-UiTM

Almost every universities in Malaysia are offering PR courses.

PR courses in Malaysia were modelled after US/UK

PR Review & PR Quarterly are US based PR journal that are available at most of the local universities' library.

Public Relation Practice



Public Relations & Media system in Malaysia

Close working relationship between public relations and media practitioners

Early stage of PR practice, most PR practitioners were former journalists

In general, Malaysian mass media have strong political connection

Media (conventional) allocate more spaces /airtime for government news

Minister attendance in any event was/is almost a must to ensure strong media coverage of the event.

COMMUNICATION
NEWS
CUSTOMERS
SALES
ADVERTISE
PROMOTE
CAMPAIGN
WEB
PUBLIC
BUSINESS
MAGAZINES
INTERNET
RELATIONS
EXPOSURE
INDUSTRY
PR
CORPORATE
TARGET
OPINION
COMMUNITY
INFORMATION